

DAY 1 GLOSSARY

Python basics, pandas, and record linkage.

Cell

One block of code in a notebook. Run it with Shift and Enter.

Kernel

The Python process behind the notebook. It remembers everything you have run.

Runtime

The machine Colab gives you. Free CPU for Days 1 and 2, free T4 GPU for Day 3.

Variable

A name pointing at a value, made with `=`.

List

An ordered collection, written `[1, 2, 3]`. R's vector.

Dictionary

Key to value pairs, written `{'left': 0}`. Label maps live here.

Comprehension

Building a list in one line, `[f(i) for i in x]`. R's `sapply`.

Import

Loading a library once, near the top, for the whole session.

Indentation

Leading spaces that mark a block. In Python they are part of the grammar.

Traceback

The error report Python prints. The last line names the problem.

KeyError

You asked for a column or dictionary key that is not there. Check the spelling.

TypeError

You combined two incompatible types, such as text and a number.

DataFrame

A pandas table. R's `data.frame`.

Series

One column of a DataFrame.

value_counts

Counts of each distinct value in a column. R's `table()`.

Record linkage

Joining two datasets that describe the same things under different names.

difflib

Python's built-in string similarity. Compares spelling, character by character.

Threshold

The similarity score above which you auto-accept a match. We use 0.8.

Crosswalk

A dictionary mapping one dataset's names onto another's.

Embedding

Numbers standing for meaning. Lets you match Burma to Myanmar.

Cosine similarity

How close two embeddings point in the same direction. 1 is identical.